



Stellar Origins

MEANING WORKSHOP

DESIGNING A CAREER THAT MATTERS

"We have calcium in our bones, iron in our veins, carbon in our souls, and nitrogen in our brains. 93 percent stardust, with souls made of flames, we are all just stars that have people names." — Nikita Gill

Welcome to Luma: People and Purpose's Meaning Workshop, Stellar Origins. We're excited to have you join us on this journey of exploring what makes work and life meaningful to you.

Throughout the workshop, we encourage you to be as honest and open with yourself as possible, while giving yourself permission to enjoy the process, explore new perspectives, and discover something along the way.

The workshop includes both digital and tactile activities. As you move through each activity, use this workbook to capture your thoughts and reflections. You can answer the questions as they arise, between activities, or whenever you feel most comfortable. There are no right or wrong answers. This is your space to pause, reflect, and explore what matters to you.

Expanding your Universe

DISCOVERING MEANING THROUGH PERSPECTIVE

Sometimes, what we see depends on where we are standing. In this activity, explore how different perspectives can reveal pieces of a bigger picture and shape the way we understand meaning.

1. How did you decide what the image was based on the limited information you had?
2. How do our experiences, values, relationships, and assumptions shape the manner in which we interpret the world around us?
3. How did your assumption of the object change as you were exposed to more information from your fellow students?

- 4. How often do we form conclusions in our work or personal lives based on incomplete information?
- 5. What did the activity illustrate to you about the importance of context in reaching a meaningful conclusion?
- 6. How do our beliefs, expectations, and previous experiences shape the meaning we attribute to information or events?

Forge your Star

DISCOVERING WHAT MAKES YOU SHINE

Every star has its own story, shaped by what makes it unique. In this activity, you'll explore your values, choices, and aspirations, and how they shape what makes life and work meaningful to you.

Scan the QR code below to enter the Stellar Origins digital experience and begin the activity. As you journey through the digital activities, use this workbook to capture your thoughts and reflections along the way.



1. Looking at the character you created, what does it tell you about what you value, what matters to you, or the kind of person you want to become?
2. How might these values or aspirations influence the choices you make about your work, relationships or future?

Chart your Galaxy

FINDING YOUR PLACE AMONG THE STARS

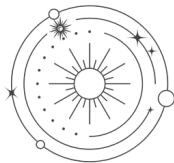
Just as every galaxy has its own unique makeup, every workplace offers different conditions for people to find meaning and thrive. In this activity, you'll explore the values, environments and experiences that matter to you at work.

Every galaxy has its own character, shaped by the values, people and possibilities within it. Before discovering where you might fit, take a moment to explore the four galaxies and what makes each one unique.

Andromeda Galaxy

CLAN
CULTURE

(ESTABLISHED IN 1988)



ANDROMEDA GALAXY

— ESTD. 1988 —

SLOGAN: *"With every voice we forge ahead together"*

MISSION: "Building an environment where every employee feels they belong, their voice matters, and their contributions help shape meaningful and lasting impact."

VALUES:

- People-centred
- Respect
- Diversity and Inclusion
- Trust

Phoenix Cluster

ADHOCRACY
CULTURE

(ESTABLISHED IN 2018)



SLOGAN: *"Growing daily, flourishing for tomorrow"*

MISSION: "Cultivating an environment of continuous learning, curiosity, and growth, where every employee is supported to reach their full potential and contribute to progress."

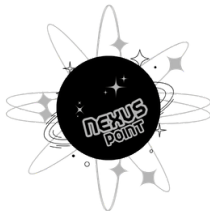
VALUES:

- Resourceful
- Innovation
- Energised and Optimism
- Learning

Nexus Point

HIERARCHICAL
CULTURE

(ESTABLISHED IN 2002)



SLOGAN: *"Connected through trust built for purpose"*

MISSION: "Building trusted relationships, empower people to work together, achieve meaningful goals, and create lasting positive impact."

VALUES:

- Integrity
- Accountability
- Professional
- Consistency

Triangulum Galaxy

MARKET
CULTURE

(ESTABLISHED IN 1954)

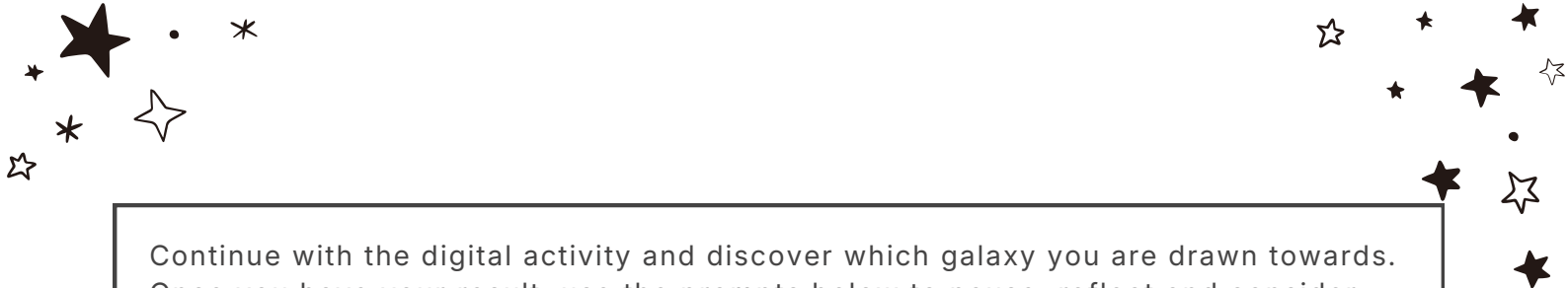


SLOGAN: *"As one we rise, Bound for greatness"*

MISSION: "Uniting talented people around ambitious goals, delivering innovative solutions and measurable impact while striving for excellence in everything we do."

VALUES:

- Ownership
- Client-driven
- Striving for excellence
- Collaborating for impact



Continue with the digital activity and discover which galaxy you are drawn towards. Once you have your result, use the prompts below to pause, reflect and consider what it reveals about the kind of environment in which you might find meaningful work.

1. What does your result suggest about the conditions you may need to experience meaning at work?
2. Which part of your result resonates with you most, and which part challenges or surprises you?
3. If your values shape what makes work meaningful to you, what might happen when your values and your organisation's culture do not align?

When Work Goes Off Course

CRAFTING YOUR WAY BACK TO WHAT MATTERS

Even the best journeys can encounter unexpected turbulence. When circumstances change, what once made our work meaningful can suddenly feel uncertain or out of reach.

In this activity, you'll navigate one of the provided workplace disruptions. Explore what matters most to you, and consider how you might chart a new course back towards meaning.



Restructuring

You have spent two years as the HR Business Partner for two departments, gradually building strong relationships with managers and employees. People come to you for guidance, and you take pride in supporting both the people and the business.

This morning, leadership announces that the two departments will merge into one function next month. You can see the logic behind the decision. The current structure has caused duplication and confusion, and you have previously suggested that a more integrated structure could work better.

However, the new structure has not been finalised yet. Leadership says there is "some overlap in HR support roles", but no one can tell you exactly what this means for your position. Your manager tells you privately that she does not yet know whether your role will continue as it is, change significantly, or disappear altogether.

Project cancellation

Eight months ago, you proposed a new employee wellbeing and engagement initiative. It was not an obvious priority for the organisation, but you believed it could genuinely make a difference for employees.

You developed the proposal, secured a modest budget and led the project from its launch. Over time, the initiative became something you were proud to be associated with. Recent engagement results showed a positive shift in the areas the programme was designed to address.

This morning, you receive an email informing you that the initiative is being deprioritised with immediate effect and the working group is being disbanded. You later learn that another team's initiative has been chosen instead. It costs less and has outcomes that are easier to demonstrate to senior leadership.

Your project did not fail. However, the work you cared about is no longer a priority, and the organisation has moved on. You still believe employee wellbeing matters. You are now left wondering how, or whether, you can continue pursuing that purpose through your work.

Leadership change

Your Head of Talent has led the Learning and Development function for three years. You have become accustomed to her leadership style. She gives you space to work independently, trusts you to solve problems and supports you publicly, even when she challenges you privately.

At the same time, you have sometimes felt frustrated by her reluctance to address certain performance issues within the team. You value the autonomy she gives you, but you also recognise the limitations of her leadership style.

She announces that she is leaving the organisation. Two weeks later, her replacement arrives from the Finance division. Your new manager takes a very different approach: they are highly involved, strongly focused on measurable outcomes, and expect clear evidence of return on investment from every programme. Within your first month, you are asked to provide more frequent reports, justify decisions that previously required little explanation and obtain approval for changes you would previously have made independently. Nothing about your job title has changed. But the way you experience and perform your work has.

Resource cut

You manage an employee wellbeing programme that has gradually become an important part of the organisation. It is relationship-focused, and its impact is not always easy to capture in a quarterly report, but employees regularly attend, and several have privately told you that the programme made a meaningful difference during difficult periods.

You have spent the past year building the programme largely through your own initiative. The budget has never been large, but it has been enough to keep the programme running consistently.

During this quarter's planning meeting, you are told that the programme's budget will be reduced by more than half as part of a company-wide efficiency drive. Leadership explains that the programme's impact is "difficult to measure". You know this is a fair criticism. Although you have collected positive feedback, you never developed a strong system for demonstrating longer-term outcomes.

You are now expected to deliver similar outcomes with significantly fewer resources. No one has suggested that the programme is unimportant, but the way you can deliver it has fundamentally changed.

You still believe the work matters. You now have to decide what that means when you cannot do the work in the same way.

1. Think of a time when something disrupted your experience of work, study or another meaningful activity. What value or purpose felt threatened?
2. What could you change about what you do, who you connect with, or how you view the situation to reconnect with what matters to you?
3. What have you learned about the relationship between your values, purpose and the experience of meaning?

One Last Look at your Universe

UNTIL OUR PATHS
CROSS AGAIN

Throughout this journey, you've explored how perspective, values, workplace environments and unexpected changes can shape your experience of meaning.

If you could carry one insight from Stellar Origins into your future work and life, what would you want to remember about what makes life meaningful to you? Take a moment to write down whatever comes to mind. There is no right answer.

Thank you for joining us on Stellar Origins and for being willing to pause, reflect and explore what matters to you. We hope you leave with a deeper understanding of your own sources of meaning, and with the confidence to notice, protect and create meaning throughout your journey.

Your path may change. Your galaxy may evolve. But you get to keep discovering what makes the journey meaningful.

Thank you for journeying with Kalea and Kirithi from Luma: People and Purpose.

